

Yuqi HUANG

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PERSONAL SUMMARY

I am a PhD student in Economics at the University of Auckland specialising in labour economics, with a focus on gender wage inequality and the role of labour market institutions. My research examines how policies such as unionisation, workplace flexibility, and childcare support interact to shape labour market outcomes, using applied microeconomic methods and longitudinal data. I have experience in panel data analysis, instrumental variable estimation, and policy evaluation, with proficiency in Stata, R, and SQL. My work aims to generate rigorous, policy-relevant insights that contribute to the design of more equitable and efficient labour market institutions.

EDUCATION BACKGROUND

University of Auckland, New Zealand

09/2024 - Present

PhD Candidate in Economics

- Research Focus: Economics Essays on the Impact of Labour Market Institutions on the Gender Wage gap
- Courses: Applied Microeconometrics (A-), Behavioural and Applied Economics (A)

University of Manchester, UK

09/2022 - 12/2023

Master of Economics

- Grade: Distinction (74%)
- Core courses: Macroeconomics (83%), Further Econometrics (84%), Mathematics for Economists (78%)

Shenzhen University, China

09/2018 - 07/2022

BSc in Economics, Finance

- GPA: 3.8/4.5, Upper second-class honor; Ranking: Top 20% of the college
- Core courses: Macroeconomics (90%), Quantitative methods (90%), Calculus C (89%), Linear Algebra (94%), Microeconomics (87%)

TEACHING ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

Econ 211 Macroeconomics Analysis, University of Auckland

07/2025 – 12/2025

Position: Teaching Assistant

- Marked assignments, quizzes, and exams for undergraduate courses with careful attention.
- Provided written feedback to support students' learning and understanding of core economic concepts.
- Conducted tutorial session and held office hours to clarify assessment questions and assist with course material.

PUBLICATION

Huang, Yuqi (2024).

The Ramsey Model's Insight on Long-Term Growth Amidst Brexit and the COVID-19 Pandemic

Advances in Economics, Management and Political Sciences (Conference Proceedings), Vol. 77, pp. 172–176.

DOI: <https://doi.org/10.54254/2754-1169/77/20241850>

- Examines long-run growth dynamics using the Ramsey model under major exogenous shocks (Brexit and COVID-19).

THESIS

The Trade-Off Between Union Wage Gains and Working Time Flexibility: How Gender Benefits Are Partially Offset, PhD Provisional Year's thesis

- **Contribution:** Conducted original econometric analysis of the trade-off between union wage premiums and working-time flexibility in Australia using HILDA longitudinal data (2001–2022). Applied instrumental variable estimation to show that while unions provide higher wage gains for women (15.1% vs. 10.1% for men), reduced flexibility offsets these benefits. Developed a novel mediation framework, revealing that flexibility constraints diminish unions’ gender-equalizing potential, with asymmetric costs across genders, income levels, and family structures.

An Econometric Investigation into the Effect of an Aging Population on Economic Growth in East Asia Pacific,
Master’s thesis

- **Contribution:** Utilizing fixed-effect regression models on data from 27 countries (1992-2021), the study reveals a negative correlation between population aging and GDP in East Asia Pacific. However, it also highlights that the adverse effects of aging can be mitigated through increased labour force participation and consumption, suggesting a nuanced interaction between demographic shifts and economic variables. It offers policy recommendations to adapt to demographic changes for regional economic planning.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

New Statistics for Human Capital Distribution and New Results: Barriers to Women’s Education and the Poverty of Nations, Dr. Erwann Sbai & Professor Debasis Bandyopadhyay, University of Auckland 07/2025 – 01/2026

- Assisted in econometric modelling of cross-country growth regressions using panel data and instrumental variable (IV) estimation to assess how gender gaps in education affect long-run productivity and income.
- Conducted robustness and diagnostic tests (Hausman, Hansen J, Kleibergen–Paap) to verify instrument validity and model consistency.
- Organized regression outputs, interpreted coefficient patterns, and contributed to report sections explaining estimation strategy and results.

CONFERENCE

Australian Gender Economics Workshop 2026, Monash University 02/2026

- Presented my PhD research on the trade-off between union wage premiums and working-time flexibility, with a focus on its implications for gender wage inequality.
- Received constructive feedback from leading scholars, contributing to the refinement of the empirical strategy and interpretation of findings.
- Actively engaged with academic peers, fostering research collaborations and exchanging insights on contemporary issues in labour economics.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Financial Skills:

- CFA Level III CANDIDATE

Awards:

- Second Prize in the 2019 PwC LEAP Programme Competition (May 2019)
- Second Prize in the 2019 National Management Decision Simulation Competition for Innovation and Entrepreneurship (March 2019)

Honours:

- CFA Scholarship of Shenzhen University for Spring 2021
- “The Best” Diligent and Studious Scholarship of the School of Economics, 2021

Contact Details of References

- Prof Sholeh Maani, Professor University of Auckland: s.maani@auckland.ac.nz